

Visitor Welcome Display — Setup Guide

Publishing and updating the RingCentral Rooms welcome screen with GitHub + Netlify

This sets up the visitor welcome screen so it runs on the shop TVs and can be updated from any laptop — no USB drives, no Azure. RingCentral points at **one web address that never changes**. Behind that address the page re-reads a small schedule file every 30 seconds, so **to change who's shown you just edit one file on GitHub** and the screens update themselves within about half a minute.

What you need

- The **burkes-welcome-signage** folder of files (from Nick).
- A free **GitHub** account — <https://github.com>
- A free **Netlify** account — <https://www.netlify.com>
- Access to the **RingCentral Admin Portal**.

Part 1 — Put the files on GitHub

1. Sign in at **github.com** and click **New repository** (the green button, or the + at top right).
2. Name it **burkes-welcome-signage**, leave it Public, and click **Create repository**.
3. On the new repo page, click the “**uploading an existing file**” link (or **Add file → Upload files**).
4. Drag in everything from the folder: **welcome.html**, **schedule.json**, **_headers**, **netlify.toml**, and the whole **logos** folder.
5. Scroll down and click **Commit changes**. The files are now on GitHub.

Part 2 — Connect Netlify to the repo

1. Sign in at **app.netlify.com** — use “**Sign in with GitHub**” so the two are linked.
2. Click **Add new site → Import an existing project → GitHub**, then pick the **burkes-welcome-signage** repo.
3. Leave the build command **empty** and publish directory as **`.`** (a dot). Click **Deploy**.
4. After ~30–60 seconds Netlify shows a site address like **https://your-site.netlify.app**. Your page is that address plus **/welcome.html**.
5. (Optional) In **Site configuration → Change site name**, rename it to something tidy such as **burkes-welcome**, giving you **https://burkes-welcome.netlify.app/welcome.html**.

Copy that **/welcome.html** address — that's the URL RingCentral uses.

Part 3 — Point RingCentral at the URL

In the **RingCentral Admin Portal**: **Meetings → Rooms → Rooms List**, then for each room:

1. Open the room → **Display Settings** tab.
2. In the **URL** field, paste **https://your-site.netlify.app/welcome.html**.
3. Set **Operation Time** to **always-on** — leave the scheduling to the page (it's more precise).
4. Repeat for all the rooms — every screen uses the **same** URL.

Set the Rooms device clock to **Central Time** so the on/off times land at 6am/5pm CT.

Part 4 — Updating a visitor (the everyday task)

To change who's shown, edit **schedule.json** right on GitHub — nothing else to touch:

1. In the GitHub repo, click **schedule.json**, then the **pencil (Edit)** icon.
2. Change or add a visitor block (format below), then click **Commit changes**.
3. Netlify redeploys automatically; the screens refresh within ~30 seconds. **Same URL**.

A visitor block looks like this:

```
{
  "company": "Acme Steel",
  "logo": "logos/acme.png",
  "brandColor": "#0057B8",
  "note": "Plant tour, 2 pm",
  "start": "2026-09-10T08:00:00",
  "end": "2026-09-10T17:00:00"
}
```

- **company** is required; **logo**, **brandColor**, and **note** are optional (no logo → the big name shows).
- New logo? Upload the image into the **logos** folder in the repo and reference it by that path.
- **Times have no time zone** — they follow the display device's clock (Central Time).
- Before the start time, after the end time, or with no active visitor, the screen goes **black**.

Right now it's set to **Clayco, Thursday 9/3, 6:00am–5:00pm** (no-tagline logo).

Good to know

- The Netlify site is **public** (anyone with the link can view it) — fine for a lobby screen; don't put anything sensitive in **note**.
- It needs **internet** — if the plant connection drops, the screens hold their last state.
- Using RingCentral Rooms also requires the **Rooms app installed and paired** on each ThinkCentre, the TV switched to the ThinkCentre's **HDMI input**, and a **Rooms license per screen** (TUSCOM).